EXPERIMENT 7

Integrating a Zoho Creator Application with Another Zoho Service using Connections and APIs

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Subject: Low Code Application Development using Zoho Creator
Project: Bank Loan Application & Pre-Screening Management

Aim

To integrate the Loan_Application_Form with Zoho Calendar through a Microservices connection, so that a verification callback is scheduled automatically for every submitted application at the applicant's preferred callback time.

Introduction

Applications rarely work alone. A loan officer already plans the day in a calendar, so a callback that exists only inside the loan application is easily missed. Zoho Creator lets an application call another service in two ways: a **connection** (an authorised link to a service, with scopes) and an **API call** from Deluge using that connection. The connection handles sign-in and permissions; the script decides what to send.

Procedure

Phase A — create the connection

1. Open the application and go to **Microservices → Connections**.
2. Click **Create Connection** and choose the Zoho Calendar service from the list of default services.
3. Give the connection a link name, for example **zoho_calendar_connection**, and select the scopes needed to create events.
4. Click **Create and Authorize** and accept the permission prompt. The connection should now show as active.

Phase B — prepare the form

1. Make sure Loan_Application_Form has Preferred_Callback_Time and a date for the callback. Add a Date field **Callback_Date** if it is not present, because the Time field alone does not carry a date.
2. Add a Single Line field **Calendar_Event_Status** to store the outcome of the call.

Phase C — add the workflow

1. Open **Workflow → Form workflows** and create **Sync_To_Calendar_Workflow** with the trigger *Create → On success*.
2. Add a Deluge script action and paste the script of Code 7.1, adjusting the calendar UID and the data-centre domain.
3. Save and submit a test application; check the response stored in Calendar_Event_Status and look for the event in Zoho Calendar.

```
// Code 7.1 — Sync_To_Calendar_Workflow (reference implementation)
// Assumptions: connection link name zoho_calendar_connection; Callback_Date and a 30-minute slot.
// Check the Zoho Calendar API reference for the exact endpoint and date format of your data centre.
start_dt = input.Callback_Date.toString("yyyyMMdd") + "T" + input.Preferred_Callback_Time.toString("HHmmss"
eventData = Map();
eventData.put("title", "Loan callback - " + input.Applicant_Name.first_name + " (" + input.Loan_Application
eventData.put("description", "Verify documents for " + input.Loan_Type + " application");
dt = Map();
dt.put("timezone", "Asia/Kolkata");
dt.put("start", start_dt);
dt.put("end", start_dt);          // replace with start + 30 minutes in the format required by the API
eventData.put("dateandtime", dt);
params = Map();
params.put("eventdata", eventData.toString());
response = invokeurl
[
    url        : "https://calendar.zoho.in/api/v1/calendars/<CALENDAR_UID>/events"
    type       : POST
    parameters : params
    connection : "zoho_calendar_connection"
];
info response;
input.Calendar_Event_Status = ifnull(response.get("code"), "see log");
```

Code 7.1 — Creating a calendar event with invokeurl

The script is a reference implementation. The end time, the exact date format and the endpoint depend on the Zoho Calendar API version and the data centre of the account, so they have to be confirmed against the Zoho Calendar API reference, and the response checked in the execution log, before the result is relied on.

Key Configuration Points

Table 7.1: Configuration of the integration

Item	Setting	Reason
Connection link name	zoho_calendar_connection	The script refers to the connection by this name; a mismatch is the most common error
Scope	Permission to create events	A connection without the scope returns an authorisation error
Trigger	On Create → On success	The record and its ID exist at this point
Time zone	Asia/Kolkata	Keeps the event at the applicant’s preferred local time
Failure handling	Store the response in Calendar_Event_Status	Submission is not blocked if the calendar call fails

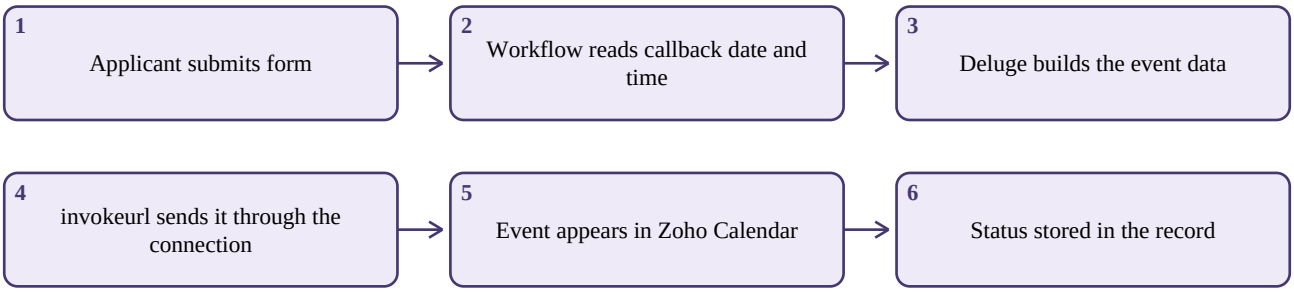


Fig 7.1 — Integration flow (schematic drawn from the specification; not a screenshot)

Output

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Microservices → Connections page showing zoho_calendar_connection as active

Fig 7.2 — Connection created

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Sync_To_Calendar_Workflow with the Deluge script

Fig 7.3 — Workflow and script

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Zoho Calendar showing the callback event created for a test application

Fig 7.4 — Event in Zoho Calendar

SCREENSHOT TO ATTACH

Loan_Application_Report showing Calendar_Event_Status for the test record

Fig 7.5 — Status stored in the report

Result

A Zoho Calendar connection was created and a form workflow was configured so that each submitted loan application schedules a callback event.

Conclusion

A connection plus a short invokeurl call is enough to link a Creator application to another Zoho service. The connection holds the authorisation, the script holds the logic, and storing the response in the record makes failures visible instead of silent.